

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 2
 ♥ J 9 7 6 2
 ♦ A 9 8 4 3
 ♣ 4

♠ K 10 8 7 4

♥ A 3

♦ 5 2

♣ A J 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 5 3

♥ Q 10 8 4

♦ K Q J 10

♣ K 8 6

♠ A Q J 6

♥ K 5

♦ 7 6

♣ Q 10 9 7 3

West	North	East	South
------	-------	------	-------

Pass	1 ♠	Pass	1 ♣
------	-----	------	-----

Pass	4 ♠		2 ♠
------	-----	--	-----

All Pass

4 ♠ by North
of those times.

North is to play 4 ♠. East leads the ♦ K. West overtakes with the ♦ A and returns the ♣ 4.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 3

This looks like a walk in the park. If West has the ♣ K you can let that ♣ 4 ride around to dummy and end up making 12 tricks! What could go wrong?

What could go wrong is that East could win the ♣ K and return a ♣ which West ruffs. West could then play a ♦ back to East's ♦ Q, who could play another ♣ which West could again ruff. You could go down 2. That's what could go wrong.

Now, what should go right. Just because the lesson had many examples where you delayed pulling trumps, it is still true that **MOST OF THE TIME** you should pull trumps immediately. And this is one

So grab your ♣ A at trick 2, pull trumps no matter how many pulls it takes, then establish the ♣ s. The contract is cold.

For most suit contracts the immediate pulling of trumps should be the first priority.

Clear thinking is important, too. Can you imagine any Bridge player in the West seat overtaking his partner's opening lead just so he could then underlead his ♣ K into dummy's ♣ Q?

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 4

♥ K J 9

♦ J 9 5

♣ Q J 10 4

♠ Q 10 2

♥ 6 2

♦ A 8 7 4

♣ 8 6 5 3



♠ 7

♥ A 8 5 4 3

♦ Q 10 3 2

♣ K 7 2

♠ A K J 9 6 3

♥ Q 10 7

♦ K 6

♣ A 9

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South

If they play another ♠ it will be just the second and dummy will still have one ♠ left to ruff your ♥ loser.

South is to play 4 ♠. West leads the ♣Q.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=3 ♦=0 ♣=1 Total = 4

You can't help the ♣ loser, but the ♥ loser can be ruffed in dummy. The most important question right now is how many rounds of trumps to pull before you give up a ♥?

None would be the correct answer. Suppose you decide to go over to dummy with the ♠Q so as to lead a ♥ toward your ♥ Q 10 7. When West won the trick he would probably play another trump. Then when you gave up a second ♥ dummy's final trump might be removed.

Win the first trick and play a ♥ from your hand. If they play a ♠, win in your hand and play another ♥.

At the first hint that you might be thinking of ruffing losers in dummy the defenders are going to start leading trumps to try to prevent you.

So you must stay a jump ahead of them. In this Deal the only way they could have gotten the jump on you would have been with a trump opening lead.